

KNOWLEDGEABLE

Action Plan & Implementation Roadmap

Original Concept — Educational Media Platform

Solo Founder | Bootstrap | Pilot-First

1. Pre-Launch Checklist

Complete before spending any money on content or marketing. Estimated time: 2–3 weeks.

1.1 Legal & Administrative

- ☐ Register domain name (knowledgeable.co.uk or similar) — ~£10/year
- ☐ Decide on company structure (sole trader initially, Ltd when revenue justifies it)
- ☐ Register with ICO for data protection — £40/year
- ☐ Set up business bank account (Starling or Monzo Business — free)
- ☐ Get basic public liability insurance — ~£100–£200/year

Estimated cost: £150–£300

1.2 Platform Setup

- ☐ Choose CMS and hosting (WordPress + managed hosting or custom build)
- ☐ Set up Stripe for payments (subscriptions + one-time purchases)
- ☐ Build site structure: Home, News, Media Literacy, Academic, Exam Revision, Skills, Tutoring
- ☐ Design basic branding (logo, colour scheme, typography) — Canva or Fiverr (£20–£50)
- ☐ Set up YouTube channel with branding
- ☐ Create social media accounts (Instagram, TikTok, Twitter/X)

Estimated cost: £200–£500 (hosting, domain, design)

1.3 Initial Content Planning

- ☐ Select 5 launch GCSE subjects: Maths, English, Biology, Chemistry, Physics
- ☐ Select 3 launch A-Level subjects: Maths, Biology, Chemistry
- ☐ Plan 15–20 skills courses for launch library
- ☐ Create content templates (revision guide template, flashcard format, PPT template)
- ☐ Identify and contact 5–10 freelance content creators (teachers, tutors, postgrads)
- ☐ Plan first 10 media literacy resources (fake news guides, example articles)

Estimated cost: £0 (planning only)

2. Phase 1: Build (Months 1–2)

Goal: Build the website and produce enough content for a credible launch.

2.1 Content Production

- Commission 50 GCSE revision guides across 5 subjects (10 per subject) — £30–£80 each
- Create 20 sets of digital flashcards (4 per subject)
- Produce 10 PowerPoint revision aids
- Write 10 media literacy articles (how to spot fake news, source evaluation, bias detection)
- Create 5 'fake news lab' exercises with example articles
- Commission 15 skills courses from practitioners (revenue share or £100–£300 per course)
- Write 10 academic simplification articles (aerospace, quantum physics, economics, etc.)

Estimated content cost: £3,000–£5,000

2.2 Platform Development

- Build and test all website sections
- Set up subscription system (£10/month skills, £8/month video)
- Implement flashcard system (spaced repetition)
- Set up content management workflow for freelance contributors
- Test payment processing end-to-end

2.3 End-of-Phase Checkpoint

- ☐ Website live (even if not public)?
- ☐ 50+ revision guides published?
- ☐ 15+ skills courses ready?
- ☐ Payment system tested and working?

If 3/4 YES, proceed to soft launch. If not, extend by 2 weeks.

3. Phase 2: Soft Launch (Month 3)

Goal: Test with a small audience, gather feedback, fix problems before going public.

- Share the platform with 50–100 people: friends, family, teachers you know, student contacts
- Ask 10–15 students to use the revision materials and give honest feedback
- Test the skills library with 5–10 users
- Monitor site performance, loading times, mobile responsiveness
- Fix bugs, improve navigation, adjust content based on feedback
- Write 5 news curation pieces to test the format and workflow

3.1 End-of-Phase Checkpoint

- ☐ Users can navigate and find content without confusion?
- ☐ Payments process correctly?
- ☐ Feedback is positive on content quality?
- ☐ Site loads properly on mobile?

If 3/4 YES, proceed to public launch.

4. Phase 3: Public Launch (Month 4)

Goal: Open to the public and start driving traffic.

- Announce on social media (Instagram, TikTok, Twitter/X)
- Post first YouTube video (platform tour, or a 'how to spot fake news' explainer)
- Contact 10–20 secondary schools to introduce the platform (email to heads of department)
- Post in student communities (Reddit r/GCSE, r/6thForm, The Student Room)
- Begin daily news curation (2–3 stories per day, multi-source comparison)
- Track: daily visitors, sign-ups, time on site, which content gets most views

4.1 Monthly Targets (Months 4–6)

Metric	Month 4	Month 5	Month 6
Monthly Visitors	1,500	3,000	5,000
Registered Users	300	800	1,500
Skills Subscribers	15	40	80
Content Pieces Published	80	120	160

5. Phase 4: Growth (Months 5–12)

Goal: Expand content, launch tutoring, reach 8,000 MAU and 400 paying subscribers.

5.1 Content Expansion

- Expand to all GCSE subjects (target: full coverage by Month 8)
- Add A-Level coverage for 3 more subjects (total 6)
- Grow skills library to 30+ courses
- Publish academic simplification articles weekly
- Daily news curation becomes routine (founder-led, 2–3 hours/day)

5.2 Tutoring Marketplace Launch (Month 6)

- Recruit 5 tutors through teaching networks and university contacts
- Vet tutors: qualifications check, DBS verification, trial session
- Build simple booking system (Calendly integration or custom)
- Set commission rate: 25% to Knowledgeable
- Target: 50 tutoring sessions by end of Year 1

5.3 YouTube & Marketing

- Publish 2–4 YouTube videos per month (revision tips, media literacy, subject explainers)
- Use YouTube to drive traffic to website (not as a standalone platform)
- Grow social media following through consistent posting (3–5 posts/week)
- Explore school partnership model (free access for schools, paid premium for individuals)

5.4 End-of-Year Checkpoint

- ☐ 8,000+ MAU?
- ☐ 400+ paying subscribers?
- ☐ 50+ tutoring sessions facilitated?
- ☐ Full GCSE coverage?
- ☐ £25K+ total revenue?

If 4/5 YES, proceed to Year 2 scaling. If not, identify which pillar is underperforming and focus resources there.

6. Decision Gates

Gate	Timing	Continue	Pivot	Kill
Gate 1	Month 3	50+ test users, positive feedback, site works	Feedback negative on 1–2 pillars: drop weakest, focus on strongest	Nobody uses it, fundamental concept rejected
Gate 2	Month 6	3,000+ MAU, 80+ subscribers, growing week-on-week	MAU growing but conversions low: adjust pricing or free/paid boundary	Flat traffic despite marketing. Reassess positioning.
Gate 3	Month 12	8,000+ MAU, 400+ subscribers, £25K+ revenue	Some pillars strong, others weak: double down on winners	Revenue below £10K and no growth trajectory. Pivot to exam-only or wind down.

The kill criteria exist to prevent sinking time into something that isn't working. If the platform genuinely fails, the fallback is to strip it down to a focused GCSE revision site (the most proven market) or repurpose the content library as a freelance tutoring portfolio.

7. Budget & Spending Timeline

Phase	Timeline	Key Costs	Total
Pre-launch	Weeks 1–3	Domain, hosting, insurance, design	£350–£800
Phase 1: Build	Months 1–2	Content production (50 guides, 15 courses, media literacy)	£3,000–£5,000
Phase 2: Soft Launch	Month 3	Minor fixes, hosting costs	£100–£300
Phase 3: Public Launch	Month 4	Marketing push (social ads, school outreach)	£500–£1,000
Phase 4: Growth	Months 5–12	Ongoing content, tutoring setup, marketing	£5,000–£10,000
Year 1 Total	12 months		£9,000–£17,000

This is genuinely bootstrap-friendly. The largest cost is content production, and that scales with revenue — you only commission more content as the platform grows and generates income to fund it. A founder with £5,000 in savings can launch and sustain the platform through to revenue generation.

8. Risk Contingencies

Risk	Contingency
BBC Bitesize makes free content redundant	Differentiate on breadth (news, media literacy, skills). Bitesize won't add these.
Low conversion from free to paid	Test different pricing, bundle options, limited-time offers. The skills library is the primary conversion driver.
Can't recruit quality tutors	Delay tutoring launch. Focus on skills and content subscriptions instead. Tutoring is 25% of revenue, not 100%.
Content quality issues	Strict editorial review. Reject poor content. Better to have less content at higher quality than more at variable quality.
Copyright complaint (news curation)	Link to sources, don't reproduce. Use fair use for commentary. Legal review of curation practice before launch.